



Tearful exit: 2024 saw the curtains brought down on the illustrious career of Sunil Chhetri, one of India's greatest-ever footballers. GETTY IMAGES

Rollercoaster of emotions

2024 delivered everything we came to expect — renewed hope, heartbreak, and unforgettable additions to the annals of footballing history.

Aneesh Dey & Neeladri Bhattacharjee
aneesh.dey@thehindu.co.in, neeladri.b@thehindu.co.in

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nother year has gone by, and football continues to live up to its reputation as the 'Beautiful Game'. Here is what 2024 gave us in the world of football.

Winds of change

Indian football reached a nadir in 2024 when the men's national team failed to win a single game in a calendar year — its first such failure in 16 years (having played at least five games).

The Blue Tigers started the year riding on

the optimism of winning three trophies the previous year as it built momentum towards the AFC Asian Cup.

What unfolded afterwards was a shock for thousands of Indian fans in Qatar as their side lost all three group-stage games, failed to score a single goal, and made an early exit from the tournament.

India's captain, Sunil Chhetri, shed